

ENGLISH FOR WORK / SEPTEMBER 2026

Telecommunications English



Learner workbook

Work with realistic cases, develop your own response, and use the answer section after you have tried the tasks.

PRACTICE THAT TRANSFERS TO WORK

Read a realistic case. Study complete conversations. Find the right language, speak, get feedback, and try again.

Eight lessons | Intermediate to advanced | Independent or classroom study

For network operations staff, telecom engineers, field technicians, customer operations teams, product managers, regulatory staff, and telecom project leaders.

All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

All scenarios, figures, and model responses are fictional teaching material. Use invented details in practice.

[Open this course on English Ladder](#)

Your course at a glance

Use the lesson numbers to match this document with the website and the other guides.

01 Network Operations and Outage Bridges

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact.

02 Fiber Deployment and Construction Coordination

Give a handoff that the receiving person can confirm.

03 Wireless Capacity and Coverage

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

04 Provisioning and Service Activation

Clarify missing information before responding.

05 Field Service and Dispatch

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

06 Regulatory and Emergency Services

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

07 Customer Churn and Service Recovery

Acknowledge a communication problem and give a corrected message.

08 Vendor and Equipment Lifecycle

Compare options using the same criteria and state the tradeoff.

Choose your pace

Quick practice: spend 15 minutes reading one conversation and rehearsing one scenario. Full lesson: allow 45-60 minutes for language work, three conversations, two speaking scenarios, and feedback.

Level support

B1 learners can use the frames and a partner. B2 learners can try a response before reading the model. C1 learners can add the harder follow-up and reduce preparation time. These are teaching suggestions, not certified CEFR level ratings.

After practicing: open the AI prompt workshop to choose a vocabulary, grammar, role-play, or new-dialogue activity.

LESSON 01 / READ AND NOTICE

Network Operations and Outage Bridges

Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact.

SITUATION

A network incident affects one service area. Fault isolation is ongoing, and no restoration estimate has been verified.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

NOC - Network operations center: a team or location coordinating network monitoring and operational response.

outage - A period during which a service is unavailable.

fault isolation - Narrowing down where a technical problem originates.

ETA - Estimated time of arrival; an estimate should be distinguished from a confirmed time.

3. Notice the language

Lead with the current state, then the important change or open item. Use completed-action language only for completed work. Add a next update point when it is known; do not invent a date to make the message sound complete.

We have completed ...; ... remains open.

As of ..., the status is

The next update will cover

Compare this wording: Everything is progressing well.

LESSON 01 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Give a useful status update

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence says a review is finished?
 - A. The team is completing the review.
 - B. The team plans to complete the review.
 - C. The team has completed the review.
2. Which update distinguishes a plan from a confirmed fact?
 - A. The delivery plan proves that arrival will be Friday.
 - B. Delivery is planned for Friday; the carrier has not confirmed it.
 - C. Delivery is confirmed for Friday because we planned it.

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

No verified restoration estimate

The lesson's outage bridge covers one affected service area; fault isolation continues and no restoration estimate has been verified.

01 • NOC analyst: The outage affects one service area. Fault isolation is ongoing, and we have no verified restoration estimate.

02 • Service manager: Can I tell customer support that service will probably return within the next hour?

03 • NOC analyst: We don't have evidence for that timing. Please don't turn a possible duration into an ETA.

04 • Service manager: Understood. What progress can I describe without suggesting the fault has already been found?

05 • NOC analyst: Say that the network operations center is investigating the affected area; the cause remains unconfirmed.

06 • Service manager: Should support describe other areas as unaffected, or would that extend beyond the information we have?

07 • NOC analyst: Use the confirmed scope. Don't make broader claims unless the monitoring team has checked them.

08 • Service manager: I'll separate confirmed impact, investigation status, and the missing restoration estimate in the update.

09 • NOC analyst: Good. I'll pass on verified changes through this bridge rather than speculate about the repair.

10 • Service manager: I'll make clear that the next status update is not a promise of restoration.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Alarms cleared, customer checks pending

Separate fictional case: alarms on a business-access node have cleared after a recovery action, but customer-level service checks have not finished.

01 • Incident coordinator: The node alarms have cleared after the recovery action. Customer service checks are still underway.

02 • Service assurance engineer: Then should we close the outage ticket, or does the remaining verification affect closure?

03 • Incident coordinator: It matters. Cleared alarms show one improvement, but we haven't confirmed the customer experience yet.

04 • Service assurance engineer: I'll keep the service check open and avoid describing the outage as fully resolved.

05 • Incident coordinator: Can you tell the support lead exactly what has changed since the last bridge update?

06 • Service assurance engineer: The network alarms cleared; customer-level verification remains pending. We have not established a root cause.

07 • Incident coordinator: That distinction is useful. Please don't imply that the recovery action proves what caused the fault.

08 • Service assurance engineer: Agreed. I'll record the action and observed result without presenting the sequence as causal proof.

09 • Incident coordinator: Bring the verification results back to the bridge when they are available, including any remaining failures.

10 • Service assurance engineer: I will. Closure can then be considered against the actual results and our incident process.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A monitoring gap after maintenance

Separate fictional case: after planned maintenance, traffic counters are visible but latency telemetry is missing; no customer outage has been confirmed.

01 • Shift supervisor: We can see traffic counters again, but the latency telemetry has not returned after maintenance.

02 • NOC engineer: Does that mean customers are experiencing an outage, or only that our visibility is incomplete?

03 • Shift supervisor: We have confirmed the monitoring gap, not a customer outage. Service impact still needs checking.

04 • NOC engineer: I'll describe the missing telemetry separately from the available traffic data in the handover.

05 • Shift supervisor: Please also identify which checks remain open so the next shift doesn't assume monitoring is complete.

06 • NOC engineer: The telemetry investigation and customer-impact check remain open. Neither has a confirmed completion time yet.

07 • Shift supervisor: Could the maintenance be the cause, given that the gap appeared afterward?

08 • NOC engineer: It may be related, but the timing alone doesn't establish that. We'll examine the change records.

09 • Shift supervisor: Good. Keep the status precise and avoid giving a restoration ETA for an unconfirmed service failure.

10 • NOC engineer: I'll report the monitoring recovery and service findings separately as the evidence becomes available.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 01 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Network Operations and Outage Bridges

A network incident affects one service area. Fault isolation is ongoing, and no restoration estimate has been verified.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to brief someone who has only one minute. Ask what is complete, what is open, and which open item affects the next action.

Second round: The listener asks you to reduce the update to two sentences. Preserve the most important completed and pending items.

Model for scenario 1: The affected area is identified, and fault isolation is continuing. We do not yet have a verified restoration estimate. I'll state the next update time and revise the message when confirmed information is available.

Scenario 2 | A dashboard with stale timestamps

In a fictional operations center, a dashboard displays green status but its last update was forty minutes ago. A separate ticket reports connection failures at one branch. Give a status update without treating the dashboard as current evidence.

Role A: You are the NOC analyst. Explain the stale timestamp and outstanding verification.

Role B: You are the incident manager. Ask what is known about branch impact and who will check it.

Possible opening: The dashboard is green, but its data is forty minutes old, so current service status is not verified.

Success checks

- Distinguish displayed status from current verified status.
- Keep the reported branch failure separate from confirmed wider impact.
- Agree checks for both monitoring freshness and the branch report.

Add a complication: A colleague wants to dismiss the branch ticket because there is no red alarm.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 02 / READ AND NOTICE

Fiber Deployment and Construction Coordination

Give a handoff that the receiving person can confirm.

SITUATION

A fiber installation team has completed physical work but an inspection is still pending. The next team assumes the route is ready.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

fiber - Optical fiber used to transmit signals as light.

make-ready - Preparatory work needed before new telecommunications equipment or lines can be installed.

splicing - Joining sections of optical fiber using an appropriate technical process.

permit - Official permission for an activity under specified requirements.

3. Notice the language

State the current situation, relevant background, open task, and receiving role. Ask for acknowledgment or repeat-back of the critical item. Sending a message and transferring responsibility are not always the same thing.

The current status is ...; the outstanding item is

The record shows

Please confirm who has accepted

Compare this wording: Someone should follow up on this.

LESSON 02 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Transfer information and responsibility

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence checks that responsibility has been accepted?
 - A. The check appears somewhere in the notes.
 - B. Please confirm who will complete the outstanding check.
 - C. I mentioned the check in my earlier email.
2. Which response best checks a critical handoff detail?
 - A. So the result is pending and your team will follow up; is that correct?
 - B. I assume all results are final, so we can finish.
 - C. I saw the message, so no clarification is needed.

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Physical completion is not inspection clearance

The lesson's fiber installation is physically complete but inspection remains pending; the receiving team assumes the route is ready.

01 • Construction coordinator: The physical fiber work is complete, but inspection is still pending. I'm handing over an incomplete readiness status.

02 • Activation supervisor: Our team thought the route was ready. Are you asking us to begin service activation?

03 • Construction coordinator: No. I'm asking you to acknowledge the physical completion and the outstanding inspection separately.

04 • Activation supervisor: Understood. Who will provide the inspection result so we know when to reconsider the next stage?

05 • Construction coordinator: I'll coordinate that update with the inspection owner. I don't yet have a confirmed result or timing.

06 • Activation supervisor: Should we also verify the handover records for splicing and any relevant permit conditions?

07 • Construction coordinator: Yes. Use the actual records rather than inferring their status from physical completion.

08 • Activation supervisor: I'll keep the receiving task pending and tell my team that route readiness is not confirmed.

09 • Construction coordinator: Please repeat the main dependency when you brief them, so the distinction survives the handoff.

10 • Activation supervisor: Physical work is complete; inspection and readiness verification remain outstanding. We await your evidence-based update.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Splice records and the wrong route label

Separate fictional case: a fiber handover package names route F12, while its splice diagram is labeled F21; neither team knows which label is correct.

01 • Field coordinator: This handover names route F12, but the attached splice diagram says F21. The route identity needs checking.

02 • Network records specialist: Could that be a typing error, or are we looking at two different fiber routes?

03 • Field coordinator: Either is possible. I can't confirm which, so please don't relabel the diagram on an assumption.

04 • Network records specialist: I'll hold the records update and compare the source package with the project references.

05 • Field coordinator: I'll contact the construction lead for the verified route identifier and the corresponding splicing record.

06 • Network records specialist: What should I tell the provisioning team if they ask whether the documentation is ready?

07 • Field coordinator: Say the package was received but contains an unresolved identity mismatch. Receipt doesn't mean acceptance.

08 • Network records specialist: Understood. My task is document verification, and yours is obtaining confirmation from construction.

09 • Field coordinator: Correct. Once we reconcile the identifiers, I'll send a clearly versioned replacement handover package.

10 • Network records specialist: I'll acknowledge the corrected package and confirm which records have actually been updated.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Make-ready ownership at a shared site

Separate fictional case: a project uses make-ready to mean site preparation. The civil contractor has completed the duct inspection; the building-access confirmation remains with the property team.

01 • Civil works coordinator: The duct inspection is complete. Building access remains unconfirmed, and the property team owns that check.

02 • Fiber deployment lead: Our schedule says make-ready complete. Does that label include building access in this project?

03 • Civil works coordinator: It should not imply that all preparation is finished. Only the duct inspection is complete here.

04 • Fiber deployment lead: I'll correct our readiness summary before the installation crew receives its assignment.

05 • Civil works coordinator: Please carry forward the access dependency and the property team's responsibility in your handover.

06 • Fiber deployment lead: Can you transfer the completed inspection record while I contact the property coordinator?

07 • Civil works coordinator: Yes. I'll send the identified record, but I cannot authorize site entry on their behalf.

08 • Fiber deployment lead: Understood. Receiving the inspection record doesn't give the crew permission to enter the building.

09 • Civil works coordinator: Exactly. Let me know whether the property team accepts ownership of the access confirmation.

10 • Fiber deployment lead: I'll obtain that acknowledgment and keep crew scheduling conditional on the remaining project checks.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 02 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Fiber Deployment and Construction Coordination

A fiber installation team has completed physical work but an inspection is still pending. The next team assumes the route is ready.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are taking over the work. Ask what remains open and repeat back the critical status or responsibility. Point out one detail that would be unsafe or misleading to assume.

Second round: The intended recipient cannot take ownership. Keep the status clear and identify the need for an authorized reassignment.

Model for scenario 1: Physical installation is complete; the inspection remains pending. Please confirm the approved status before scheduling the next activity, and record the outstanding item in the handoff.

Scenario 2 | An incomplete test attachment

A fictional fiber handover includes installation photographs and a test-results attachment that cannot be opened. The installation coordinator has the original file; the receiving engineer has not reviewed its results. Conduct a handoff and agree how to resolve the missing evidence.

Role A: You are the installation coordinator. Explain what was sent and arrange a readable replacement.

Role B: You are the receiving engineer. Confirm receipt of the photographs but not acceptance of unseen test results.

Possible opening: You have the installation photographs, but I understand the test attachment did not open.

Success checks

- Separate email receipt from technical acceptance.
- Assign responsibility for resending and reviewing the test record.
- Read back the outstanding acceptance dependency.

Add a complication: The project manager wants the handover marked accepted because the email was delivered.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 03 / READ AND NOTICE

Wireless Capacity and Coverage

Explain a useful distinction in plain English.

SITUATION

Customers report slow service in a busy area even though the coverage map shows signal availability.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

spectrum - The range of radio frequencies used for wireless communication.

coverage - The protection provided by an insurance policy; in telecommunications, the area with service availability.

capacity - Available people, assets, time, space, or system throughput for a given workload.

congestion - Demand exceeding the available capacity of a network or transport route.

3. Notice the language

Start with the reader's question. Explain one unfamiliar term with familiar words, then give a relevant example or contrast. Check understanding without asking only 'Do you understand?'.

In this context, ... means

The difference is that

How would you explain that distinction to a colleague?

Compare this wording: We need to operationalize the implementation.

LESSON 03 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Make a complex point clear

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence explains 'backlog' rather than repeating it?
 - A. The backlog is the work still waiting to be completed.
 - B. The backlog is the work completed during the last period.
 - C. The backlog is the maximum work the team can finish in a period.
2. Which follow-up best checks whether your explanation was clear?
 - A. Would you like me to repeat the explanation?
 - B. Was the explanation detailed enough for you?
 - C. How would you describe the next step in your own words?

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Signal on the map, slow service on the street

The lesson's customers report slow wireless service in a busy area despite mapped signal coverage.

01 • Customer operations lead: Our map shows coverage in the busy area. Why are customers still reporting slow service?

02 • Radio planner: Coverage describes signal availability. Capacity concerns how much demand the network can handle in the relevant conditions.

03 • Customer operations lead: So a coverage map doesn't promise that every user will get the same speed?

04 • Radio planner: Correct. Think of reaching the network and sharing its available resources as different questions.

05 • Customer operations lead: Could congestion explain these reports, or would saying that overstate what we've checked?

06 • Radio planner: It is a possible explanation, not a confirmed diagnosis. We need measurements from the reported times and locations.

07 • Customer operations lead: I'll ask support to capture those details instead of answering every report with the coverage map.

08 • Radio planner: Good. Also avoid saying that adding spectrum automatically resolves this particular problem; we haven't assessed it.

09 • Customer operations lead: My explanation will distinguish having a signal from having sufficient resources during busy periods.

10 • Radio planner: Exactly. Then we can investigate the reports without treating mapped coverage as proof of service performance.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

An empty venue test is not an event test

Separate fictional case: a wireless demonstration worked in an empty exhibition hall; the organizer asks whether that proves performance during a crowded event.

01 • Event connectivity manager: The demonstration worked in the empty hall. Can we promise the same experience when visitors arrive?

02 • Wireless engineer: The test shows performance under that test load, not under the expected event demand.

03 • Event connectivity manager: Is that the distinction between coverage and capacity, even though the building stays the same?

04 • Wireless engineer: Yes. The signal may reach the space while many simultaneous users create a different capacity requirement.

05 • Event connectivity manager: Then a successful connection at every stand doesn't establish how well shared service will perform.

06 • Wireless engineer: Exactly. We need an agreed demand profile and a suitable assessment before making event claims.

07 • Event connectivity manager: What should I explain to exhibitors who heard that the wireless test passed?

08 • Wireless engineer: Say the empty-hall connectivity test passed; performance under event load has not yet been verified.

09 • Event connectivity manager: I'll clarify that distinction and collect the expected use cases rather than inventing a guaranteed speed.

10 • Wireless engineer: I'll use those requirements to propose the next assessment and explain its limits in plain language.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Indoor reception and shared capacity

Separate fictional case: office users report weak reception in a basement and slow downloads at lunchtime upstairs; neither symptom has been diagnosed.

01 • Facilities manager: Staff describe both problems as poor coverage: weak basement reception and slow lunchtime downloads upstairs.

02 • Radio engineer: Those reports may involve different issues. Coverage and capacity are related, but they aren't interchangeable labels.

03 • Facilities manager: Could you explain the difference without assuming either problem has already been diagnosed?

04 • Radio engineer: Weak reception concerns signal availability at a location. Slow downloads can have several causes, including shared demand.

05 • Facilities manager: So the basement report suggests a signal question, while lunchtime suggests a time-dependent performance question?

06 • Radio engineer: Yes, as investigation directions, not findings. We still need measurements and the affected service details.

07 • Facilities manager: Would moving upstairs solve the lunchtime problem if people can already see a strong signal there?

08 • Radio engineer: We can't conclude that. A signal indicator doesn't measure every factor affecting the download experience.

09 • Facilities manager: I'll keep the location and timing reports separate when I ask staff for examples.

10 • Radio engineer: That will help us investigate coverage and possible congestion without forcing both symptoms into one explanation.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 03 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Wireless Capacity and Coverage

Customers report slow service in a busy area even though the coverage map shows signal availability.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are unfamiliar with one technical term in the case. Ask for a plain-English explanation and then paraphrase it. Do not pretend to understand a term you cannot explain.

Second round: Your listener is new to this field. Replace two specialist expressions with clear explanations without changing the meaning.

Model for scenario 1: Coverage and capacity describe different issues. A signal may be available while busy-period demand affects performance. I'll explain that distinction and report the observed conditions for investigation.

Scenario 2 | More bars after a handset change

In a fictional office, one employee's new handset shows more signal bars, but no controlled speed or call-quality comparison has been made. Discuss what the observation does and does not establish.

Role A: You are the support supervisor. Ask whether the handset proves the network has gained capacity.

Role B: You are the radio analyst. Explain indicator readings versus measured service performance in ordinary language.

Possible opening: More signal bars on one handset do not establish that the network now has more capacity.

Success checks

- Distinguish an indicator from a controlled service measurement.
- Avoid diagnosing the handset or network from one observation.
- Agree a comparable test before making a wider recommendation.

Add a complication: The supervisor wants to recommend replacing every handset based on this observation.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 04 / READ AND NOTICE

Provisioning and Service Activation

Clarify missing information before responding.

SITUATION

A service-activation request has a customer address but no circuit reference or requested activation date.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

provisioning - Configuring systems or resources so a service can be supplied to a user.

CPE - Customer premises equipment: communications equipment located at the customer's site.

circuit - A telecommunications connection or path used to carry a service.

service activation - The process of making a configured service available for customer use.

3. Notice the language

Name the exact word, fact, or requirement you need clarified. Ask one focused question at a time. Repeat your understanding and give the other person a chance to correct it.

When you say ..., do you mean ...?

Could you clarify which ...?

So, my understanding is Is that right?

Compare this wording: Could you explain what does this mean?

LESSON 04 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Ask a precise question

4. Check the language

1. Which indirect question has the usual word order?
 - A. Could you confirm when does the review start?
 - B. Could you confirm when starts the review?
 - C. Could you confirm when the review starts?
2. Someone says the report is 'ready.' Which question best clarifies its approval status?
 - A. Who will present the report at the meeting?
 - B. Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review?
 - C. Can you send the report to me this afternoon?

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

An address does not identify the circuit

The lesson's service-activation request includes an address but lacks a circuit reference and requested activation date.

01 • Provisioning specialist: I have the customer address, but which circuit does this service-activation request concern?

02 • Account coordinator: The request doesn't contain a circuit reference. I need to obtain it from the customer owner.

03 • Provisioning specialist: Please confirm that identifier before we match the request to a service at the address.

04 • Account coordinator: Could we use the address alone and add the circuit reference after activation?

05 • Provisioning specialist: That leaves the service identity unresolved. We should clarify it before planning the activation work.

06 • Account coordinator: Understood. You also need the requested activation date, which is missing from the request.

07 • Provisioning specialist: Correct. Please distinguish the customer's preferred date from any date our delivery team has confirmed.

08 • Account coordinator: Should I ask about the CPE as well, meaning the equipment at the customer's premises?

09 • Provisioning specialist: Yes, obtain the relevant equipment details through the normal intake process rather than assuming readiness.

10 • Account coordinator: I'll return with the circuit reference, requested date, and available equipment information, with any gaps clearly marked.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Replacing equipment or adding service?

Separate fictional case: an order says upgrade at branch B7 and names an existing circuit; it does not say whether the customer wants new premises equipment or a service change.

01 • Order manager: The order says upgrade for circuit B7. Does that mean replacing CPE or changing the service?

02 • Customer technical lead: I can see why that's unclear. Our internal note uses upgrade without specifying the desired outcome.

03 • Order manager: Could you clarify what should be different for users after the work is completed?

04 • Customer technical lead: I need to check with our network owner rather than guess which change they intended.

05 • Order manager: Please do. Equipment replacement and service provisioning could require different information and coordination.

06 • Customer technical lead: Should I also confirm whether the existing service is expected to remain available during the work?

07 • Order manager: Yes. State that as a requirement for review, not as something we have already guaranteed.

08 • Customer technical lead: Understood. I won't tell the branch that an activation date has been agreed yet.

09 • Order manager: Once the requested change is clear, we can identify the appropriate planning and approval steps.

10 • Customer technical lead: I'll clarify the outcome with our network owner and return with a specific request.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

Which date is the requested date?

Separate fictional case: a provisioning form shows delivery on the tenth and activation on the twelfth; the customer's email asks for service on the tenth.

01 • Activation coordinator: Your email requests service on the tenth, but the form lists activation on the twelfth.

02 • Customer project manager: The tenth is when equipment is due. I may have used service too broadly in the email.

03 • Activation coordinator: Could you confirm whether you need usable connectivity on the tenth or only equipment delivery?

04 • Customer project manager: I need to verify that with the branch team before I give you a firm requirement.

05 • Activation coordinator: Thank you. Delivery and service activation are separate milestones, and neither date is confirmed by this form alone.

06 • Customer project manager: Can we leave the twelfth in the plan while I check the branch's actual need?

07 • Activation coordinator: Yes, labeled as requested and under review. I won't present it as a confirmed activation slot.

08 • Customer project manager: I'll also make sure the branch understands that receiving CPE doesn't mean the circuit is live.

09 • Activation coordinator: Good. Please return with the required usable-service date, so we can assess the provisioning dependencies.

10 • Customer project manager: I'll clarify that requirement and keep the delivery date distinct when I brief everyone.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 04 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Provisioning and Service Activation

A service-activation request has a customer address but no circuit reference or requested activation date.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to know exactly what information is missing. Give one answer only after your partner asks a focused question; then ask them to confirm their understanding.

Second round: The other person uses an ambiguous word such as 'ready', 'approved', or 'urgent'. Clarify it before continuing.

Model for scenario 1: Could you confirm the circuit reference and target activation date? We need to match the request to the correct service and distinguish the requested date from a confirmed appointment.

Scenario 2 | Two suites at one address

A fictional activation request identifies a building containing suites 2A and 2B, but gives no suite number. The customer leases both, and only one needs the new circuit. Clarify the destination before provisioning proceeds.

Role A: You are the provisioning coordinator. Ask which suite and service reference the request concerns.

Role B: You are the customer's office manager. You know both suites exist but must check the destination with the IT owner.

Possible opening: Could you confirm which suite needs the new circuit? The building address identifies two possible locations.

Success checks

- Ask for the exact destination without guessing.
- Identify the customer owner who can confirm it.
- Keep service planning conditional on the correct location and reference.

Add a complication: A colleague suggests choosing 2A because that suite appears first in the customer record.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 05 / READ AND NOTICE

Field Service and Dispatch

Make a request with a clear action, purpose, and realistic timing.

SITUATION

A field technician receives a ticket that says only "internet bad." The customer is available for a clarification call.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

truck roll - A field-service visit requiring a technician to travel to a site.

signal level - The measured strength of a communications signal under specified conditions.

dispatch - Coordinating and assigning resources for an operational task.

inside wiring - Telecommunications wiring within a customer's building or premises.

3. Notice the language

State the action and the information needed. Explain why it matters and specify a deadline only when one is given or agreed. 'Could you' is polite; repeated apologies can obscure a legitimate request. Urgent situations may require a direct request.

Could you provide ... so that ...?

Please confirm ... by [agreed time].

If that timing is not possible, please let me know

Compare this wording: Please revert soonest with the necessary.

LESSON 05 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Ask for an actionable next step

4. Check the language

1. What does 'Please send it by Thursday' normally mean?
 - A. Keep sending it regularly until Thursday.
 - B. Send it no later than Thursday.
 - C. Send it on Thursday, but not earlier.
2. Which request gives the recipient enough detail to act?
 - A. Could you confirm the document version needed for the review?
 - B. Could you confirm that the review is important?
 - C. Could you confirm that you received my earlier message?

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Turn internet bad into a usable dispatch request

The lesson's field ticket says only internet bad; the customer is available for a clarification call.

01 • Field technician: Could you arrange a customer clarification call? The ticket says internet bad but doesn't describe the symptoms.

02 • Dispatch coordinator: What information would help you prepare without asking the customer to troubleshoot unfamiliar equipment?

03 • Field technician: Please ask what stops working, when it happens, and whether it affects one device or several.

04 • Dispatch coordinator: Should I ask them to inspect inside wiring before we schedule a truck roll?

05 • Field technician: No. Start with their observations and follow our approved support process for any additional checks.

06 • Dispatch coordinator: They are available now. I can ask those questions and capture their answers in the ticket.

07 • Field technician: Thank you. Include their availability for a visit, but don't promise a repair time or diagnosis.

08 • Dispatch coordinator: Would you like me to request the existing signal-level records from service support as well?

09 • Field technician: Yes, if available through the normal channel. That would help distinguish measured information from reported symptoms.

10 • Dispatch coordinator: I'll collect the observations and available records, then confirm what dispatch can arrange.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

Site access before a truck roll

Separate fictional case: a technician is assigned to a locked equipment room, but the dispatch ticket has no authorized site contact.

01 • Field supervisor: Please obtain an authorized site contact before confirming this truck roll to the locked equipment room.

02 • Dispatch planner: The address is complete. Why can't the technician simply ask reception for access on arrival?

03 • Field supervisor: We haven't established that reception can authorize access. The visit needs a confirmed contact and arrangement.

04 • Dispatch planner: I'll ask the customer's facilities coordinator who can meet the technician and arrange the approved access.

05 • Field supervisor: Please include the person's work contact details through the ticket system, not in a public chat.

06 • Dispatch planner: Should I keep the proposed visit time or offer a different slot while I ask?

07 • Field supervisor: Ask whether the proposed time works. Don't describe it as confirmed until the required coordination is complete.

08 • Dispatch planner: Understood. This request concerns access readiness, not permission to bypass the locked room's controls.

09 • Field supervisor: Exactly. A useful dispatch request includes what the technician needs and why it matters.

10 • Dispatch planner: I'll obtain the access arrangement and report any remaining obstacle before confirming the visit.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A repeat visit needs the earlier evidence

Separate fictional case: a second technician is assigned to intermittent connection drops; the first visit's signal readings are mentioned in a ticket but not attached.

01 • Field technician: Could you retrieve the first visit's signal readings before we prepare this repeat service visit?

02 • Service coordinator: The ticket says readings taken, but it doesn't include the values or measurement conditions.

03 • Field technician: Please ask the original technician for the recorded results, including the time and measurement location.

04 • Service coordinator: Would it be enough to summarize the visit as signal normal? That's what the customer remembers.

05 • Field technician: That is a reported recollection, not the measurement record. We need to preserve the distinction.

06 • Service coordinator: I'll request the actual record and note that the customer's account is separate evidence.

07 • Field technician: Also ask whether any inside-wiring observations were recorded, without implying they explain the current drops.

08 • Service coordinator: I can request both sets of notes. I can't promise the original technician will respond before dispatch.

09 • Field technician: Then tell dispatch what remains missing, so the next visit isn't planned around assumed findings.

10 • Service coordinator: I'll send the available evidence and a clear list of outstanding questions to the receiving technician.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 05 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Field Service and Dispatch

A field technician receives a ticket that says only "internet bad." The customer is available for a clarification call.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You can help but need a clear request and its purpose. Ask what is required and whether the timing is fixed or negotiable.

Second round: The other person cannot meet the requested timing. Clarify an alternative without inventing authority to change a formal deadline.

Model for scenario 1: Could you describe what happens, when it occurs, and which devices are affected? Those details will help the field team prepare for the visit and avoid assumptions about the cause.

Scenario 2 | The symptom disappears before the visit

A fictional customer reports that intermittent calls are working again before a scheduled visit. No cause has been found and no cancellation has been agreed. Discuss what observations to request and who should decide the dispatch status.

Role A: You are the service coordinator. Request the latest symptom timing and customer availability.

Role B: You are the field supervisor. Explain what information you need before reviewing the visit plan.

Possible opening: Could you confirm when the calls started working again and whether any interruptions have happened since?

Success checks

- Request specific observations rather than declare the fault resolved.
- Distinguish a successful call from an established repair.
- Agree who will review the dispatch decision under the normal process.

Add a complication: Someone wants to cancel the visit automatically because the latest call succeeded.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 06 / READ AND NOTICE

Regulatory and Emergency Services

Separate observations, assumptions, and conclusions.

SITUATION

A customer notice describes a regulatory requirement without citing the current approved wording. The responsible team has not reviewed it.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

E911 - Enhanced 911: emergency-call capabilities that can provide routing and location information.

lawful intercept - Authorized interception of communications under applicable law and procedures.

regulatory filing - Information formally submitted to a regulator under a relevant process.

customer notice - An official communication to customers about a relevant change, event, or requirement.

3. Notice the language

Say what the evidence shows, identify what is still unknown, and limit the conclusion to that evidence. Words such as 'may', 'suggests', and 'in this sample' are useful when the uncertainty is real. Do not soften an urgent, verified safety concern.

The available evidence shows

This may indicate ..., but

We have not yet established whether

Compare this wording: The pilot proves this will work everywhere.

LESSON 06 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Match certainty to evidence

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence preserves uncertainty about an unconfirmed cause?
 - A. The change may have contributed to the delay.
 - B. The change must have caused the delay.
 - C. The change definitely caused the delay.
2. A result comes from a small pilot in one location. Which phrase accurately limits the claim?
 - A. In similar locations, we can now expect the same result ...
 - B. Across the service, the observed result was ...
 - C. In this pilot, the observed result was ...

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Unreviewed wording in a customer notice

The lesson's customer notice describes a regulatory requirement without current approved wording or review by the responsible team.

01 • Customer communications editor: This customer notice describes a regulatory requirement, but I can't find the current approved wording.

02 • Regulatory coordinator: Then we shouldn't present the statement as verified. The responsible team hasn't reviewed this draft yet.

03 • Customer communications editor: Could I keep the wording and add that requirements may vary, as a temporary solution?

04 • Regulatory coordinator: A general caveat doesn't establish that the specific claim is correct. We need the appropriate review.

05 • Customer communications editor: I'll mark that section pending and ask for the source and applicable customer scope.

06 • Regulatory coordinator: Good. Keep any E911 or emergency-service description tied to the reviewed service and context.

07 • Customer communications editor: So I should not borrow language from another notice just because the service names look similar?

08 • Regulatory coordinator: Correct. We haven't confirmed that the wording applies here or that the older notice is current.

09 • Customer communications editor: I'll route the draft with the unresolved claims identified rather than publish an unsupported explanation.

10 • Regulatory coordinator: I'll obtain the responsible team's response and distinguish approved wording from questions still under review.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

A filed document is not a confirmed approval

Separate fictional case: a project tracker shows a regulatory filing submitted; no response from the reviewing body has been recorded.

01 • Program manager: The regulatory filing is submitted. Can the status slide say approval complete for the launch meeting?

02 • Regulatory affairs specialist: No. Submission is recorded, but we have no recorded response from the reviewing body.

03 • Program manager: I thought filing meant that the necessary regulatory step had been accepted.

04 • Regulatory affairs specialist: Here, it means the document was sent. We must check the actual process before claiming acceptance or approval.

05 • Program manager: Then I'll state submitted and leave the review outcome unresolved in the project status.

06 • Regulatory affairs specialist: Please also avoid assuming that submission alone establishes permission for any customer-facing change.

07 • Program manager: Could you identify which confirmation the project needs next, using the applicable internal guidance?

08 • Regulatory affairs specialist: Yes. I'll check with the responsible reviewer and report the required next step.

09 • Program manager: That gives us a factual update without inventing a legal conclusion or a response date.

10 • Regulatory affairs specialist: Exactly. We'll keep the filing record separate from whatever decision or acknowledgment follows.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A sensitive inquiry is not a validated instruction

Separate fictional case: a sales inbox receives a message labeled lawful intercept inquiry; the sender's authority and the request's applicability have not been verified.

01 • Sales operations lead: We received an email labeled lawful intercept inquiry. Should I tell the customer we'll comply immediately?

02 • Compliance liaison: No. The label doesn't establish the sender's authority, authenticity, or what action is applicable.

03 • Sales operations lead: I won't interpret the request. Which facts can I state when I escalate it?

04 • Compliance liaison: State that the email was received and that validation is pending. Use the designated restricted review channel.

05 • Sales operations lead: Should I forward the full message to the general account team so everyone is informed?

06 • Compliance liaison: Keep access limited through our established process. Don't spread potentially sensitive details unnecessarily.

07 • Sales operations lead: Understood. I can record receipt without describing the message as a verified legal demand.

08 • Compliance liaison: Exactly. The authorized team needs to assess it before anyone makes commitments or takes action.

09 • Sales operations lead: I'll route it for review and avoid customer-facing claims about our obligations or response timing.

10 • Compliance liaison: I'll confirm receipt by the responsible team while keeping the substantive outcome explicitly unresolved.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 06 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Regulatory and Emergency Services

A customer notice describes a regulatory requirement without citing the current approved wording. The responsible team has not reviewed it.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to tell a colleague what is known. Ask which part is confirmed and which part is an assumption. Challenge one statement that sounds more certain than the case supports.

Second round: Someone asks for a yes-or-no answer when the evidence supports only a qualified answer. Be concise while preserving the uncertainty.

Model for scenario 1: The notice needs review against the current applicable requirement and approved language. I'll identify the disputed wording and route it to the responsible team before release.

Scenario 2 | An old emergency-service slide

A fictional sales deck contains an emergency-service slide copied from an older product. The current product and customer location differ, and no specialist review has occurred. Discuss how to qualify the deck's readiness without giving emergency-service guidance.

Role A: You are the sales enablement lead. Identify the unverified claims before the presentation.

Role B: You are the regulatory liaison. Request review against the current product and applicable context.

Possible opening: This slide comes from another product, so its emergency-service claims are not yet verified for this presentation.

Success checks

- Distinguish prior use from current applicability.
- Avoid asserting a regulatory requirement or service capability.
- Agree to obtain authorized wording before using the claims.

Add a complication: A presenter says the slide has been used before and therefore must be safe to reuse.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 07 / READ AND NOTICE

Customer Churn and Service Recovery

Acknowledge a communication problem and give a corrected message.

SITUATION

A customer asks for an update after repeated service interruptions. The investigation has no confirmed root cause.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

churn - Loss of customers, revenue, employees, donors, users, or accounts over a period of time.

SLA credit - A credit provided under a service-level agreement when specified service conditions are not met.

root cause - Underlying reason a problem occurred, not merely the visible symptom.

service assurance - Activities that monitor and maintain whether a service meets its intended performance requirements.

3. Notice the language

Name what was unclear or wrong, acknowledge its effect, and correct it. A brief apology can help, followed by a practical next step. Avoid explaining away the other person's reaction or promising an outcome you cannot control.

My earlier message did not make ... clear.

I'm sorry for The correct information is

Let me check that the revised explanation addresses

Compare this wording: I'm sorry if you failed to understand.

LESSON 07 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Repair a misunderstanding

4. Check the language

1. Which apology takes responsibility for unclear wording?
 - A. I'm sorry the process took longer than expected.
 - B. I'm sorry we could not meet the original date.
 - C. I'm sorry my earlier wording was unclear.
2. What should follow an apology for an incorrect date?
 - A. A new guaranteed date even if it is unverified.
 - B. The corrected date and the current confirmation status.
 - C. A longer explanation that never states the correct date.

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Correcting a premature root-cause message

The lesson's customer asks about repeated service interruptions; the investigation has no confirmed root cause.

01 • Service assurance manager: I need to correct our earlier message. We described a cause before the investigation had confirmed it.

02 • Customer IT manager: That made us think the repeated interruptions were understood. What can you actually tell us now?

03 • Service assurance manager: The investigation remains open, and the root cause is not confirmed. I'm sorry our wording suggested otherwise.

04 • Customer IT manager: Can you at least promise the interruptions won't happen again after the next check?

05 • Service assurance manager: I can't make that promise from the current evidence. I can give you verified findings as they emerge.

06 • Customer IT manager: Please separate the investigation from any discussion of an SLA credit. We need clarity on both.

07 • Service assurance manager: Agreed. Credit eligibility needs the applicable service agreement and review; it isn't established by this conversation.

08 • Customer IT manager: A consistent contact would help. We keep having to explain the same history to different people.

09 • Service assurance manager: I'll coordinate the service assurance updates and confirm the contact arrangement through our account team.

10 • Customer IT manager: Thank you. Accurate updates will be more useful than another confident explanation that later changes.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

An update time was mistaken for a repair time

Separate fictional case: a support email promised an update at three; its subject line said service restored at three, but no restoration time is confirmed.

01 • Account service lead: Our subject line was wrong: three o'clock is the next update time, not a confirmed repair time.

02 • Customer operations manager: We arranged work around that subject line. The correction changes what our staff can plan.

03 • Account service lead: I understand, and I'm sorry for the misleading wording. Restoration timing is still unconfirmed.

04 • Customer operations manager: Will your next message actually contain a fix, or might it just report that investigation continues?

05 • Account service lead: It may report continued investigation. We'll distinguish the update commitment from the unresolved service estimate.

06 • Customer operations manager: Please correct the original message in the same channel so our branch managers see it.

07 • Account service lead: I will, and I'll place the correction first rather than bury it beneath technical detail.

08 • Customer operations manager: Could you also make the time zone explicit? Our teams work in different regions.

09 • Account service lead: Yes. I'll use the agreed update time with its time zone and keep restoration status separate.

10 • Customer operations manager: That gives us a reliable communication plan even while the service investigation remains open.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A ticket closure did not resolve the complaint

Separate fictional case: a service ticket was administratively closed while the customer's recurring dropouts remained under a separate investigation; the closure message implied resolution.

01 • Customer care supervisor: Our closure message suggested the dropouts were resolved. That was inaccurate; the separate investigation remains open.

02 • Customer IT lead: Then why did we receive a message asking us to confirm that everything was fixed?

03 • Customer care supervisor: The message reflected the ticket workflow, not verified service recovery. We should have explained that distinction.

04 • Customer IT lead: Please don't make us restart the complaint just to keep the recurring fault visible.

05 • Customer care supervisor: I'll connect your complaint to the continuing investigation through our service assurance process and confirm the reference.

06 • Customer IT lead: Does that mean you know the root cause now, or only that someone is still investigating?

07 • Customer care supervisor: Only that the investigation continues. I won't imply that linking records establishes the cause.

08 • Customer IT lead: I need a clear owner and accurate status, not another generic resolved notification.

09 • Customer care supervisor: Understood. I'll correct the message and confirm ownership without promising an unverified repair or credit.

10 • Customer IT lead: Please do. That will help restore confidence that our actual service problem is being followed.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 07 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Customer Churn and Service Recovery

A customer asks for an update after repeated service interruptions. The investigation has no confirmed root cause.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You are frustrated because an earlier message created an expectation. Explain that expectation. Ask your partner to distinguish the correction from anything still uncertain.

Second round: The listener remains disappointed after the correction. Acknowledge the impact and restate the available next step calmly.

Model for scenario 1: I'm sorry the interruptions have continued. The cause is still under investigation. I'll summarize the verified service history and confirm the next update rather than repeat an unverified explanation.

Scenario 2 | A credit described as approved too early

A fictional support agent told a customer that an SLA credit was approved, but the record shows only a submitted review request. No amount or decision is confirmed. Correct the message and agree the next communication step.

Role A: You are the account service manager. Acknowledge the mistaken approval claim and explain the actual status.

Role B: You are the customer's finance coordinator. Ask whether you should adjust an internal invoice forecast.

Possible opening: I need to correct our earlier message: the credit was requested for review, not approved.

Success checks

- Acknowledge the communication error directly.
- Avoid inventing eligibility, approval, or an amount.
- Agree how the reviewed decision will be communicated.

Add a complication: The customer asks you to confirm a minimum credit amount immediately.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

LESSON 08 / READ AND NOTICE

Vendor and Equipment Lifecycle

Compare options using the same criteria and state the tradeoff.

SITUATION

One equipment proposal has a lower purchase price but an earlier end-of-support date. The replacement plan extends beyond that date.

1. Understand the situation

Identify two confirmed facts, one missing detail, and the person who needs your response. Do not fill gaps with invented facts.

2. Find the words

end of support - The point after which a supplier stops providing specified support for a product.

interoperability - The ability of systems or products to exchange information and work together.

spares - Replacement equipment or components held to support service continuity.

capital plan - A plan for investment in long-lived assets or major projects.

3. Notice the language

Use the same time period, scope, and measurement basis for both options. Explain a difference with 'whereas' or 'while'. State what improves and what is given up; do not hide the weaker side of a recommendation.

Both options ..., but

Option A ..., whereas option B

The comparison depends on

Compare this wording: This option is more better.

LESSON 08 / PRACTICE AND PRODUCE

Explain a fair comparison

4. Check the language

1. Which sentence expresses a clear contrast?
 - A. Option A is faster, so option B costs less.
 - B. Option A is faster, whereas option B costs less.
 - C. Option A is faster because option B costs less.
2. A rate increases from 6% to 7%. What is the absolute difference?
 - A. An increase of one percentage point.
 - B. An increase of one percent relative to the original rate.
 - C. An increase of seven percentage points.

05 • Conversations

The next three pages contain original fictional conversations for this lesson. Each numbered line is one speaking turn. Read the setting before assigning roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 1 OF 3

Purchase price versus the support horizon

The lesson's cheaper equipment proposal reaches end of support before the replacement plan ends; exact dates and prices are not supplied.

01 • Procurement manager: The lower purchase price looks attractive. Why shouldn't we choose that equipment for the capital plan?

02 • Network lifecycle lead: Its end-of-support date falls before the replacement plan ends, so price alone misses an important difference.

03 • Procurement manager: Does end of support mean the equipment will immediately stop working on that date?

04 • Network lifecycle lead: Not necessarily. We need the vendor's actual support terms and the implications for our planned use.

05 • Procurement manager: Then both proposals should be compared over the same operating period, including any replacement or support gap.

06 • Network lifecycle lead: Exactly. We should also compare interoperability evidence and spares availability rather than assume the devices are equivalent.

07 • Procurement manager: The cheaper option saves money initially, but may require a different lifecycle plan within our horizon.

08 • Network lifecycle lead: That's the tradeoff to investigate. We don't yet have enough information to quantify its full cost.

09 • Procurement manager: I'll request a common-period comparison and keep unconfirmed support arrangements out of the savings claim.

10 • Network lifecycle lead: I'll provide the lifecycle questions so the purchasing decision reflects the intended service period.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 2 OF 3

New versus refurbished spares

Separate fictional case: a team compares new replacement units with refurbished units; refurbished units cost less, but compatibility testing and warranty terms remain unchecked.

01 • Spares coordinator: The refurbished batch costs less than new units, but its compatibility testing and warranty terms are unverified.

02 • Network engineering lead: Can we compare acquisition cost without presenting the refurbished units as proven replacements?

03 • Spares coordinator: Yes. I'll show the price difference separately from readiness and the remaining due-diligence questions.

04 • Network engineering lead: Interoperability matters here. A matching product family name doesn't establish behavior in our deployed configuration.

05 • Spares coordinator: Would you prefer the new units automatically, given that uncertainty around the refurbished batch?

06 • Network engineering lead: Not automatically. We need comparable configuration details, support terms, and test evidence for both options.

07 • Spares coordinator: Then the apparent saving trades against additional verification and possibly different support coverage.

08 • Network engineering lead: Correct, with the extent still unknown. We shouldn't invent failure rates to justify either choice.

09 • Spares coordinator: I'll obtain the missing records and compare both batches against the same spares requirements.

10 • Network engineering lead: I'll define the relevant acceptance checks so procurement can weigh the options on a consistent basis.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 05 • CONVERSATIONS / 3 OF 3

A phased replacement or one coordinated change

Separate fictional case: a capital plan considers replacing twenty access devices together or in four groups of five; mixed-version interoperability has not been tested.

01 • Capital planning manager: Replacing all twenty devices together concentrates the work, while four groups of five spread the change activity.

02 • Network architect: The phased approach also creates a mixed-version period. We haven't tested that interoperability yet.

03 • Capital planning manager: So spreading expenditure doesn't automatically make the phased option operationally easier or lower risk?

04 • Network architect: Correct. We need to compare change effort, support coverage, and the temporary mixed environment.

05 • Capital planning manager: What does the single-change option give up in exchange for avoiding that longer mixed period?

06 • Network architect: It concentrates deployment work into one coordinated event. We need to assess available resources for that scale.

07 • Capital planning manager: Neither approach has an approved schedule yet, so I'll avoid claiming one meets a fixed completion date.

08 • Network architect: Good. Include spares and rollback planning in the comparison, without treating either plan as already validated.

09 • Capital planning manager: I'll present the two sequences against the same service horizon and list the unresolved resource questions.

10 • Network architect: I'll arrange the interoperability assessment needed to judge whether the phased option is viable.

Notice, then rehearse

Name each speaker's purpose. Identify one useful expression and the next step or unresolved question. Read the roles aloud, then switch roles.

LESSON 08 / 06 • SAY IT

Two scenarios to practice

Use only the supplied facts. Prepare for two minutes, speak for one minute, then respond to a follow-up. Switch roles and repeat. For solo study, speak both roles aloud.

Scenario 1 | Vendor and Equipment Lifecycle

One equipment proposal has a lower purchase price but an earlier end-of-support date. The replacement plan extends beyond that date.

Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You favor one option but have not checked whether the scope is comparable. Ask about one difference, then explain the tradeoff you are willing to accept.

Second round: Your listener focuses only on the lowest price or fastest date. Explain one other relevant comparison criterion.

Model for scenario 1: The lower price comes with a shorter support period. Let's compare the expected service life, support needs, and replacement timing before making the investment recommendation.

Scenario 2 | Support renewal or accelerated replacement

A fictional vendor offers one more year of support for existing equipment. Replacement equipment is available, but migration effort is not estimated. Compare renewal with replacement across the same one-year horizon without claiming either is cheaper overall.

Role A: You are the lifecycle manager. Explain the known support offer and missing migration information.

Role B: You are the capital planning lead. Ask about cost, operational effort, and what each option postpones or changes.

Possible opening: The support extension covers one year, but we need the migration estimate before comparing total costs.

Success checks

- Use the same one-year comparison period.
- Distinguish known fees from unestimated migration costs.
- State the tradeoff and identify the evidence needed for a decision.

Add a complication: A colleague treats the support fee as wasted money without considering replacement work.

Check: facts accurate | meaning clear | tone appropriate | next action or question explicit

Continue scenario 1 with an AI partner.

Answer workshop

Try the tasks first. The model is one acceptable response to scenario 1, not a script to memorize. Assess your spoken version using the four criteria at the end.

01 | Network Operations and Outage Bridges

Editing example: Three checks are complete; two remain open and are being reviewed.

The revision gives observable progress. A positive label alone does not tell the reader what is complete or still needed.

Check 1: C - The team has completed the review.

A: 'Is completing' presents the work as in progress.

B: 'Plans to complete' describes an intention, not completion.

C: 'Has completed' states that the action is finished.

Check 2: B - Delivery is planned for Friday; the carrier has not confirmed it.

A: A plan cannot prove a future arrival time.

B: This explicitly labels the date as planned and identifies the missing confirmation.

C: A plan does not establish carrier confirmation.

Model response: The affected area is identified, and fault isolation is continuing. We do not yet have a verified restoration estimate. I'll state the next update time and revise the message when confirmed information is available.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

02 | Fiber Deployment and Construction Coordination

Editing example: Please confirm which team has accepted the follow-up task.

The revised sentence asks for an identifiable receiving team instead of leaving responsibility with an unspecified 'someone'.

Check 1: B - Please confirm who will complete the outstanding check.

A: A written record alone does not identify who will act.

B: It asks for an identifiable person or team responsible for the task.

C: Mentioning a task does not show that anyone accepted it.

Check 2: A - So the result is pending and your team will follow up; is that correct?

A: This repeats the status and responsibility and invites correction.

B: It changes pending information into a final result.

C: Receiving a message is not the same as confirming its meaning.

Model response: Physical installation is complete; the inspection remains pending. Please confirm the approved status before scheduling the next activity, and record the outstanding item in the handoff.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

03 | Wireless Capacity and Coverage

Editing example: We need to put the plan into practice.

The revised sentence names the action in familiar words. Specialist vocabulary is useful when it adds precision, but repeating abstract nouns can hide the meaning.

Check 1: A - The backlog is the work still waiting to be completed.

A: This gives the meaning in familiar words.

B: Completed work is different from work still waiting.

C: This describes capacity, not the work waiting to be completed.

Check 2: C - How would you describe the next step in your own words?

A: Offering repetition may help, but it does not show how the listener understood the next step.

B: This invites an opinion on detail, not a demonstration of understanding.

C: An open request lets the listener show their understanding.

Model response: Coverage and capacity describe different issues. A signal may be available while busy-period demand affects performance. I'll explain that distinction and report the observed conditions for investigation.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

04 | Provisioning and Service Activation

Editing example: Could you explain what this means?

After an introductory phrase such as 'Could you explain', the embedded question uses statement word order: "what this means".

Check 1: C - Could you confirm when the review starts?

A: Remove 'does' and use statement word order after 'confirm'.

B: Place the subject 'the review' before 'starts'.

C: The embedded question uses subject then verb: "the review starts".

Check 2: B - Has the report been approved, or is it ready for review?

A: This asks about the presenter, not the report's approval status.

B: This question distinguishes two meanings of 'ready' that affect the next action.

C: This asks about delivery timing, not whether approval has happened.

Model response: Could you confirm the circuit reference and target activation date? We need to match the request to the correct service and distinguish the requested date from a confirmed appointment.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

05 | Field Service and Dispatch

Editing example: Could you send the missing document and confirm when it will be available?

The revision names the document and requested response. It avoids expressions that may be unfamiliar or ambiguous for an international audience.

Check 1: B - Send it no later than Thursday.

A: This interprets a deadline as a continuing activity, which would use "until".

B: 'By' sets the latest point, while 'after' refers to a later time.

C: "By Thursday" permits earlier delivery; it is not restricted to that day.

Check 2: A - Could you confirm the document version needed for the review?

A: The requested action and information are explicit.

B: This checks importance rather than identifying the needed document version.

C: This checks receipt, not which version is required for the review.

Model response: Could you describe what happens, when it occurs, and which devices are affected? Those details will help the field team prepare for the visit and avoid assumptions about the cause.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

06 | Regulatory and Emergency Services

Editing example: The pilot worked in the tested setting; performance elsewhere remains untested.

The revision states the finding and its scope. It avoids turning limited evidence into a universal claim.

Check 1: A - The change may have contributed to the delay.

A: 'May have contributed' presents a possibility without claiming the cause is established.

B: 'Must have' expresses a strong inference that the evidence may not support.

C: 'Definitely' presents the cause as certain.

Check 2: C - In this pilot, the observed result was ...

A: Similarity alone does not establish that the result will transfer.

B: A pilot in one location does not establish a service-wide observation.

C: This locates the finding in the setting actually studied.

Model response: The notice needs review against the current applicable requirement and approved language. I'll identify the disputed wording and route it to the responsible team before release.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

07 | Customer Churn and Service Recovery

Editing example: I'm sorry my message did not explain the timing clearly.

The revision takes responsibility for the message without blaming the listener. It identifies what needs to be corrected.

Check 1: C - I'm sorry my earlier wording was unclear.

A: This acknowledges duration, but does not take responsibility for the unclear wording.

B: This acknowledges a missed date, not the communication problem in the question.

C: This acknowledges the speaker's contribution to the problem.

Check 2: B - The corrected date and the current confirmation status.

A: An unsupported new promise can create a second misunderstanding.

B: A repair needs usable corrected information, including any uncertainty.

C: The reader still lacks the information they need.

Model response: I'm sorry the interruptions have continued. The cause is still under investigation. I'll summarize the verified service history and confirm the next update rather than repeat an unverified explanation.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

08 | Vendor and Equipment Lifecycle

Editing example: This option is better on cost, but slower to deliver.

'Better' already has comparative meaning, so it does not need 'more'. Naming the criterion and tradeoff makes the comparison useful.

Check 1: B - Option A is faster, whereas option B costs less.

A: 'So' implies one fact causes the other.

B: 'Whereas' marks a contrast between two options.

C: 'Because' claims a causal connection that is not given.

Check 2: A - An increase of one percentage point.

A: Subtracting 6% from 7% gives one percentage point. The relative increase is about 16.7%.

B: A one-percent relative increase on 6% would be 6.06%, not 7%.

C: The new rate is 7%; the difference between the rates is one percentage point.

Model response: The lower price comes with a shorter support period. Let's compare the expected service life, support needs, and replacement timing before making the investment recommendation.

Case check: underline the confirmed information and circle a limitation, question, or next step in the response.

Give feedback that helps

Score each criterion 0, 1, or 2. This is a practice rubric, not a professional qualification or CEFR test. Do not award or remove points for a particular accent.

Meaning and accuracy

Keeps the case facts accurate; clearly separates confirmed and unknown information.

Clarity and language

Uses understandable sentences and explains specialist terms when the listener needs it.

Interaction and tone

Responds to the other person's question, checks understanding, and uses an appropriate tone.

Task completion

Makes the requested action or unresolved question clear without inventing authority or facts.

Use the same scale for each criterion

0 - Not yet: The reader or listener cannot yet recover the intended meaning or action.

1 - With support: The message works after a prompt, clarification, or revision.

2 - Independently: The message is clear and accurate without a prompt.

Feedback sequence

First, identify a successful phrase. Next, identify one point where meaning or accuracy needs work. Offer one useful language correction, allow a repeat, and compare the two attempts. A total out of eight describes this performance only; do not translate it into a proficiency level.

Final challenge

Choose a case not rehearsed today. The learner gives a one-minute response, answers two follow-up questions, and writes a 70-110 word message. Add the lesson's second-round challenge. Compare the result with an earlier attempt using the four criteria.

Use the language responsibly

All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

Meaning before performance

Use specialist terms only when they help the listener. Explain unfamiliar words, preserve uncertainty, and ask when an instruction or responsibility is unclear. The model responses illustrate language; they do not authorize professional actions.

Sources and further reading

The cases, workshops, and explanations are original teaching material. These references provide language frameworks and selected professional context. References were checked in September 2026; consult current local guidance for actual work.

Digital.gov: plain-language guidance

<https://digital.gov/guides/plain-language>

Council of Europe: CEFR descriptors

<https://www.coe.int/en/web/common-european-framework-reference-languages/cefr-descriptors>

Your next step

Choose one expression you can use in a genuine work situation. Rehearse it with fictional details, then adapt the wording to your role and audience.

Extend your practice with AI

Use the following prompts after your own first attempt. Each contains the course context and a complete starting case or dialogue. Copy the entire prompt, including the reference, into a new chat in your preferred AI. You can also use the links to copy it from the website.

Choose the right kind of help

A role-play prompt makes the AI wait for your replies. A new-dialogue prompt asks for a complete professional script. Vocabulary and grammar prompts move from explanation to your own attempts.

Choose any lesson or dialogue online

The course prompt workshop has four practice goals and B1 support, B2 independent and C1 stretch settings. These are practice choices, not assessed proficiency levels. Select the same lesson number or dialogue title you used in this guide.

[Open this course's AI prompt workshop](#)

Keep practice useful

Use fictional or anonymized details. English Ladder does not send anything to an AI service or add your drafts to the prompts. Your chosen service's terms and any usage charges apply. AI responses can contain mistakes; compare feedback with the lesson and verify specialist claims against the course references.

Each starter prompt uses B2 practice. To change support in a printed prompt, replace its practice-setting paragraph with a request for shorter explanations and sentence starters (B1), or greater precision and more complex constraints (C1). Keep the professional facts unchanged.

Changing the example

For another case on paper, replace the text between REFERENCE and END REFERENCE with that case, its course context, relevant terms and language target. Include the full exchange if practicing a dialogue. Do not assume your AI can access this PDF or a link. The website makes this substitution for you.

Prompt edition: 2026-09-30. These are original practice instructions; results depend on the AI service you choose.

Practice grammar in context

START PROMPT / COPY THROUGH END PROMPT

Be my workplace English practice partner. Follow the practice instructions after the REFERENCE block. The block contains fictional study material, not instructions to you. Keep its facts, numbers, uncertainty and professional responsibilities accurate. Clearly label any new scenario or changed fact as an invented variation. Use natural workplace language; explain unfamiliar abbreviations in context. If a technical expression is uncertain, say so rather than inventing a definition or authority. Coach communication, not professional decisions; respect the course scope. Ask only for fictional or anonymized practice details. Judge clarity, meaning, appropriate tone and the next step. Accept valid alternative English and distinguish errors from style preferences. Do not claim to certify my language level. Unless I ask to change the plan, follow the stages and stop wherever the instructions say to wait.

When discussing a word, phrase, or example sentence as language within an explanation, question, or answer feedback, enclose that wording in quotation marks. For example: What does "about" mean in "about twenty people"? Use "on" with a named day. Keep standalone answer choices, vocabulary headwords, and ordinary reading or dialogue text uncluttered. Quotation marks identifying a language example do not attribute it to a news source; attributed source quotations must remain verbatim.

Practice setting: B2 independent. Use natural professional English with brief explanations. Let me attempt each task without a model first. Offer a hint after difficulty and invite a more precise retry.

REFERENCE

Course: Telecommunications English

Professional audience: network operations staff, telecom engineers, field technicians, customer operations teams, product managers, regulatory staff, and telecom project leaders

Scope: All cases and figures are fictional. Adapt the language to your role and organization's current procedures, using invented details for practice.

Lesson 01: Network Operations and Outage Bridges

Original fictional case: A network incident affects one service area. Fault isolation is ongoing, and no restoration estimate has been verified.

Language workshop: Give a useful status update

Communication goal: Distinguish completed work from pending work and explain its impact.

Language guidance: Lead with the current state, then the important change or open item. Use completed-action language only for completed work. Add a next update point when it is known; do not invent a date to make the message sound complete.

Useful frames (complete the gaps with case facts): We have completed ...; ... remains open. / As of ..., the status is / The next update will cover

Vocabulary: NOC: Network operations center: a team or location coordinating network monitoring and operational response. / outage: A period during which a service is unavailable. / fault isolation: Narrowing down where a technical problem originates. / ETA: Estimated time of arrival; an estimate should be distinguished from a confirmed time.

Speaking task: Prepare for two minutes. Speak for 45-60 seconds using the case facts, then respond to your partner's question. Switch roles and repeat without reading the model response.

Partner: You need to brief someone who has only one minute. Ask what is complete, what is open, and which open item affects the next action.

Writing task: Write a 70-110 word message for the person who needs to act on this case. State the purpose, preserve the relevant facts, and make the next action or unresolved question clear. Use a subject line and an appropriate opening. Do not invent a deadline, finding, or approval.

Optional second-round challenge: The listener asks you to reduce the update to two sentences. Preserve the most important completed and pending items.

Model for comparison AFTER my attempt, not a response to give me first: The affected area is identified, and fault isolation is continuing. We do not yet have a verified restoration estimate. I'll state the next update time and revise the message when confirmed information is available.

END REFERENCE

TASK: Grammar that changes the meaning

1. For a lesson, use its language workshop as the focus. For a dialogue, quote one actual sentence and select one useful grammar feature from it, such as question word order, tense, modality, conditionals or clause linking. Explain in no more than 90 words how this feature helps the speakers do their work. Keep the grammar target narrow.
2. Give two short contrasting sentences using this workplace context. Explain the difference in time, certainty, condition or politeness. Label invented examples and preserve the distinction between possible, planned and confirmed events. Describe context-dependent choices as choices, not universal rules.
3. Give me one editing or sentence-building task using a known case fact. Do not copy the supplied editing example or reveal its answer. Ask me to explain my intended meaning. Stop and wait.
4. After I answer, quote my wording, identify at most two issues, and give a brief explanation and one hint. Ask me to revise before offering a full corrected version. Then accept any accurate, natural alternative that serves the purpose.
5. Continue with two new tasks, one at a time: first guided, then an original response without a sentence frame. End with a two-sentence workplace message using the target feature and a compact self-check. Do not replace this sequence with a worksheet and answer key.

END PROMPT

Copy this prompt online or choose another lesson and support level